

Perkins&Will, beyond Vancouver

What they are building, where they are growing, and who to ask about it.
We have already worked alongside them on nine projects — that is the opening line. Everything after it is what they are doing in the other 31 studios.

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THE OPENER

Open with this

We are not a cold call. Our records show **nine projects where Perkins&Will was the architect and KOR was on the team.**

PROJECT	WHERE	DEVELOPER
Harry Jerome — Phase 1 (M4), Phase 2 (T2 & M2), Phase 3 (T1 & M1)	North Vancouver	Darwin Properties
900 Granville St	Vancouver	Bonnis Properties
600 Robson St	Vancouver	Bonnis Properties
River District Parcel 16.2	Vancouver	Wesgroup

PROJECT	WHERE	DEVELOPER
5696 Alberta St	Vancouver	Nicola Wealth Real Estate
357–475 West 41st Ave	Vancouver	Coromandel Properties

Harry Jerome is the one to name — three phases, a civic precinct, and the kind of job that gets remembered. If the person you are talking to is Vancouver-side they will know it.

► AND A SMALL HONEST CAVEAT, IN CASE IT COMES UP

Perkins&Will is set up in our system as a client in its own right, but the only record under that account — ICBC Head Office, North Vancouver — was never invoiced. **Every one of the nine above was billed to the developer, not to them.** So the relationship is real and it is a project-team relationship, not a fee relationship. Say "we have been on nine projects with you", not "you have been our client".

STRATEGY

Where the firm is placing its bets

Three moves in the last nine months tell you what they are chasing, and none of them are in BC.

- ♦ **They are building a global retail practice from scratch.** In January they hired **five principals in one go**, all from the same Amsterdam design and engineering firm — Matt Billerbeck in Seattle as Practice Leader, Sophie Bramall in Dallas, Erich Dohrer in Chicago, Sarah Holstedt in Seattle, James Mellor in San Diego. CEO Phil Harrison's stated goal: "*to build the most sought-after retail practice in the world.*" Their portfolio is shopping-centre repositioning, stadium neighbourhoods, airports, transit-oriented development and vertically integrated commercial hubs.

- ♦ **Science and technology is pivoting toward applied science.** In December they appointed **Jeff Zynda as firmwide Science & Technology Practice Leader**, explicitly to respond to a shift toward "*robotics and automation, energy systems and storage, artificial intelligence, quantum computing, and machine learning*" — working across all **32 studios**. He came from Harvard and MIT work plus projects in Ireland and the UK.
- ♦ **They bought their way into New York.** Perkins&Will merged with **A+I (Architecture Plus Information)**, a New York studio, effective September 2025.

Behind those, a steady leadership build-out through 2026: a firmwide **Director of Research and Development** hired in April from running an MIT accelerator programme; a new **Chief Marketing Officer** (Yanel de Angel) in February; new managing directors in **Boston** (Vickie Alani), **Miami** (Rosa Maria Colina), **Seattle** (Todd Buchanan) and **Toronto and Ottawa**; and new landscape architecture leadership in the **Bay Area** this month.

THE WORK

What they are building right now

Canada, outside BC

- ♦ **University of Calgary — Interdisciplinary Science and Innovation Centre.** A new academic building transforming the east campus gateway. Their Calgary studio holds it, and our own records show they took the architectural services contract for it. Worth asking where it has got to.
- ♦ **Toronto Metropolitan University — Daphne Cockwell Health Sciences Complex.** A **28-storey** health education tower in downtown Toronto, which the firm positions as its model for campus design on a dense urban site. It won a Best Tall Building award.
- ♦ Their **Calgary studio** moved into the historic Glenbow building at 822 11th Ave SW in the Beltline — a deliberately public-facing space, pitched around adaptive reuse and downtown placemaking.

United States

- ♦ **University of Louisville — Health Sciences Center**, with Champlin | EOP. Public health, medicine, dentistry and nursing brought into one building, linking the academic core to the surrounding medical district.
- ♦ **University of Houston — RAD Center**, which took the **2026 AIA Design Excellence Award for Education Facilities**.
- ♦ **LSU Health Shreveport — Emerging Viral Threats Lab**, winner of the **2026 Lab Design Excellence Award** for small project design.
- ♦ **UVA Health emergency department expansion**, recognised by IIDA.
- ♦ A **mall-to-college-campus conversion** honoured by ULI Americas in July — the adaptive-reuse story they are telling loudest right now.

International

- ♦ **A world-class science and technology museum in Suzhou, China**, unveiled in March.
- ♦ **Triple winner at the 2026 RIBA International Awards for Excellence**, and their **London studio was named Studio of the Year** at the 2026 Clerkenwell Design Week Awards.
- ♦ Two **AIA National Awards** in June.

THE OPENING

The mass timber opening — and who has that seat today

In February they published a study proposing a **prefabricated modular mass-timber system for Canadian housing**, funded with **\$250,000** of co-investment from DIGITAL's Housing Growth Innovation programme.

× THE STRUCTURAL SEAT WENT TO SOMEONE ELSE

The study's named partners are **ASPECT Structural Engineers**, Introba, and SFU's School of Interactive Arts & Technology. That is a mass-timber housing R&D programme, in Canada, with a competitor in the structural chair — and mass timber is our lane.

This is the most useful thing in the document. Two of the three people quoted on it are people we already hold contacts for:

- ◆ **Derek Newby**, quoted as Canadian Regional Director: *"We can do much better. We can start today."*
- ◆ **Kathy Wardle**, Regional Director of Regenerative Design: *"We need to leverage every opportunity to reduce the environmental impact of the built environment."*

They are also designing **BCIT's zero-carbon tall timber student housing**, announced in January. The timber conversation is live, it is funded, and the structural partner is not us.

PEOPLE

Who to ask, by studio

We hold **66 contacts** at Perkins&Will. These are the ones outside British Columbia.

NAME	ROLE	STUDIO
Derek Newby	Managing Director; Canadian Regional Director	Vancouver & Calgary
Cecily Eckhardt	Principal & Managing Director, Ontario	Toronto
Safdar Abidi	Principal, Higher Education	Toronto
Kaz Bremner	Senior Associate, Studio Co-Lead	Calgary
Marc Haberli	Associate, Studio Co-Leader	Calgary

NAME	ROLE	STUDIO
Rufina Wu	Interior Design Director	Calgary
Trevor Abramson	Managing Director, Southern California	San Diego + LA
Kay Kornovich	Managing Principal — science & technology	San Diego
Ryan Bussard	Design Principal	San Diego
Marco Marraccini	Design Director	Southern California
Michael Williams	Operations Director	Southern California
Gabrielle Bullock	Principal, Chief Diversity Officer	Los Angeles
Peter Pfau	Design Principal	San Francisco
Matt Covall	Senior Project Manager	San Francisco
Brad Hinthorne	Managing Principal	Firmwide
William Schmalz	Principal	Firmwide

► IF DEREK NEWBY IS IN THE ROOM, LEAD WITH THIS

He has had a very good year and both facts are public. In **February he was appointed to the firm's global Board of Directors**, alongside Brad Zizmor. In **May he was elevated to the RAIC College of Fellows**, cited for design innovation and climate leadership. He also runs both the Vancouver and Calgary studios and is the Canadian Regional Director — which makes him the single most useful person on this page for work outside BC.

Every one of these carries a firstname.lastname@perkinswill.com address in our system, and the full 66 including the Vancouver studio are in the BD platform under Perkins&Will.

CAVEATS

Before you quote anything

- ◆ **The nine shared projects are from our own project records** and are reliable. They are all British Columbia, and all between 2018 and 2019 — so if someone asks "what have you done with us lately", the honest answer is that the recent work has not been together.
- ◆  **Perkins Eastman is a different firm.** We hold both. Do not mix them up in conversation.
- ◆ **The firm does not publish a headcount** and neither their website nor their news releases give one. **32 studios** is from their own December release and is safe to use; a staff number is not.
- ◆ **Ownership was not confirmed for this document.** If it comes up, do not assert anything about who owns them.
- ◆ **Everything in sections 02 to 04 is from Perkins&Will's own published news**, dated December 2025 to September 2026. It is what they are saying publicly about themselves, which is exactly the right register for an event — but it is their framing, not an independent read.
- ◆ **The University of Calgary contract is in our own awards data** and predates 2026; treat its current status as a question to ask, not a fact to state.

KOR Structural — Confidential / Internal · Prepared for Omar Alcazar · 10 September 2026

Sources: KOR project records and the BD platform for the shared-project history and contacts; Perkins&Will's own newsroom for everything from December 2025 onward.